

June 17, 2020.

My thoughts on ~~oil~~ painting in oils.

1) I love the viscosity of oil paints

Unlike Acrylic, oil has certain unique qualities:

- ① - It spreads like fine butter on bread.
- ② - Every stroke of a brush, every mark of the knife is left behind beautifully
- ③ the way oil paints mix feels very real you will see a resistance to mix easily. Strands of color mix hesitantly leaving behind beautiful thin strands when poorly mixed and
- ④ the surface of an oil application (knife) looks like a perfectly flat shining surface. This glistens in the light when looked at from the sides.
- ⑤ When this perfect surface is disrupted, very abrupt cuts and lisions form.
I find these very evocative.
- ⑥ Oil dissolves in turpentine to create a very agitated powder like sheet over the painted areas.
- ⑦ ~~the~~ white (titanium white and to some extent zinc white) both are extremely powerful and offer an unmixed alteration (ununiform) to the painting surface that it is applied on.

⑧ oil paints have a strong smell and a presence that is hard to articulate.

⑨ the oil in oil paints give the pigments a rich glow. Even muddy parts feel like shining purposeful entities.

⑩ when you scratch oil paints ^⑨ the marks look like wounds when thick paint is scratched only once or twice and ^⑩ looks like a pattern brush when it is run along a stroke; ^⑪ and like scratches on the surface when ^{almost} ~~scratched~~ dry paint is scratched.

⑪ since the medium for the pigments is oil, the ^{sharp end of the} knife runs through the canvas like a hot knife on butter. It slips easily creating very bold, confident accidents.

⑫ when the palette knife is exactly parallel to the canvas (not at an incline), the paint resists any movement of the knife. this requires more force and the result is a violent resistant peaks and valleys. the result of removing the knife by lifting it up parallel to the canvas.

⑫ the thick application of oil paints gives the flat painting rich contours. this adds so much to the work when viewed sideways.

⑬ Oil paints can be applied directly to the canvas by squeezing on the tube. This is great for bold lines that make the pigment stand out.

⑭ Oil paints dry to remain exactly the same. they don't lose luster like water colors, volume like acrylics or form like acrylics.

⑮ the paintings made from oil paints → tell the story of their creation. Every stroke that went into creating a visual effect can be studied.

⑯ Oil allows me to layer paints like I do when I create on photoshop. this layering of paint strokes lets ~~st~~ lower regions peek out of the upper strokes. I love this hide and reveal. Makes the artwork feel raw, open, bold and solid.

⑰ Regardless of the number of colors and shades used, oil paints render the finished painting a sheen that somehow unifies its surface.

(18) There is almost an edible satisfaction in mixing pigments ~~to~~ before picking it up with a knife and applying it.
(some what similar to applying icing on a cake)

(19) I've found oil paints to be ruthless and unforgiving to hands, clothes and brushes. Even the slightest touch or feebleish brush through can cause the item in question to get colored.

(20) Black as a pigment is very feeble and weak - easily adulterated. → when even I use a darker color on black - eg Alizerine Chromium on black → the black takes on a completely new red sheen.

(21) Don't know how to articulate this, perhaps the baggage of all those dead painters or paintings of the past, but oils have a regal presence. The oil surrounding the pigments seem to protect its light/spare.